
NELSON MANDELA UNIVERSITY

Department of Computing Sciences

Portfolio Website – Documentation

Web Development II | WRWV201

Prepared by:

Lundi Buswana

Student Number: s221519769

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UI Design Wireframes

The following wireframes illustrate the four pages designed for the portfolio website. Each wireframe represents the planned layout and structure used during development.

Page 1 – Home (Index)

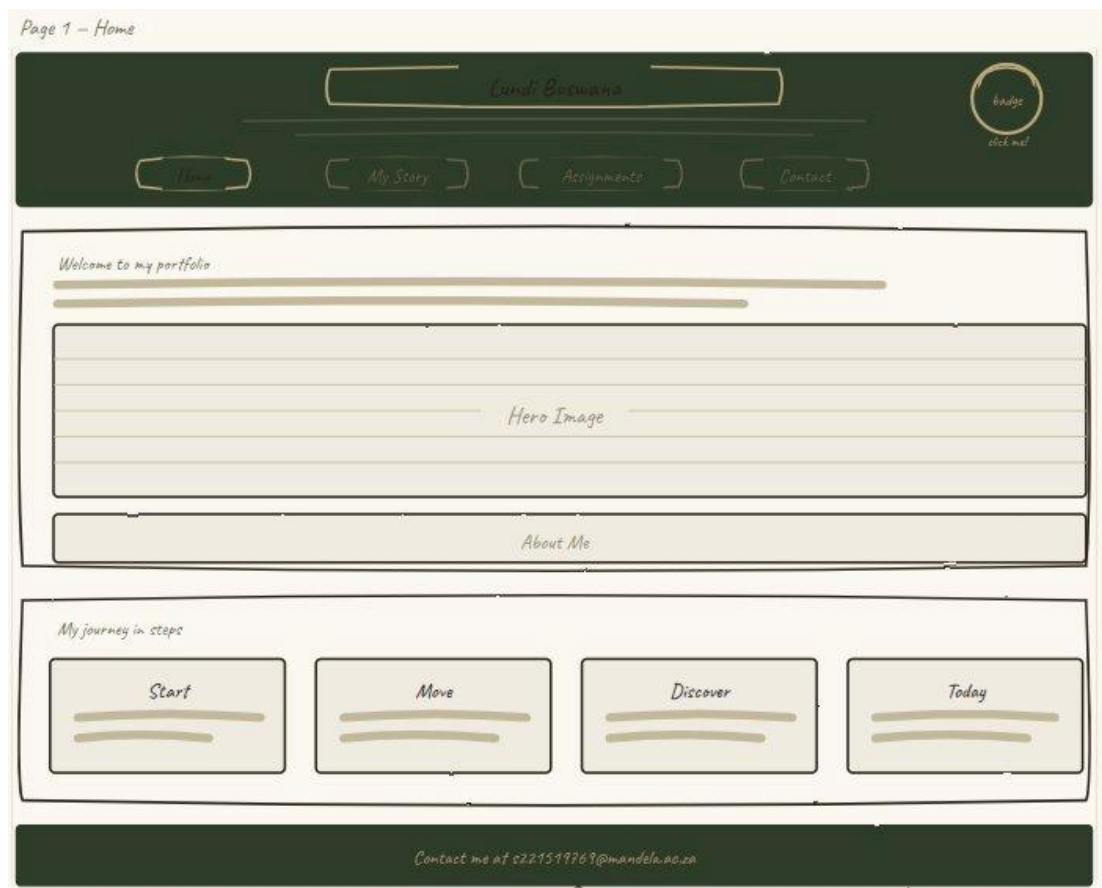


Figure 1: Home page wireframe – featuring a hero image, welcome text, About Me section, and a 'My Journey in Steps' timeline.

Page 2 – My Story

Page 2 – My Story

My Story

badge

Home

My Story

Assignments

Contact

Where I began

photo

First choices

photo

Skills & strengths

Domain	Technologies & platforms

Contact me at s221519769@mandela.ac.za

Figure 2: My Story page wireframe – divided into 'Where I Began', 'First Choices', and a Skills & Strengths table.

Page 3 – My Assignments

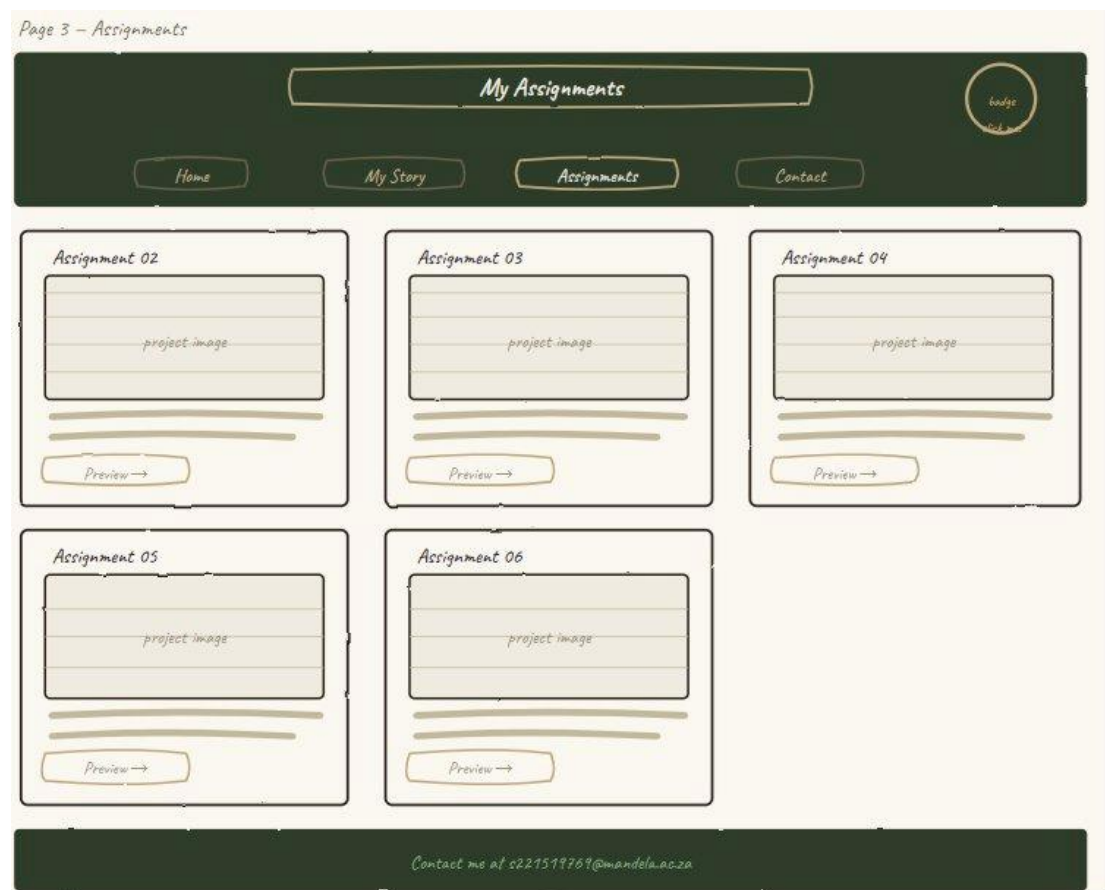


Figure 3: Assignments page wireframe – a grid of assignment cards (02–06), each with a project image, description, and Preview button.

Page 4 – Contact

Page 4 – Contact

Contact Me

Home

My Story

Assignments

Contact

body

Click me

Get in touch

Full Name:

Email Address:

Nature of Inquiry:

Select a topic... ▼

Preferred Contact Method:

☐ Gmail

☐ Outlook

Message:

How can I help you?

Send Message

Contact me at s221519769@mandela.ac.za

Figure 4: Contact page wireframe – a 'Get in Touch' form with name, email, inquiry type, preferred contact method, and message fields.

Part C: Reflection

When this portfolio project was introduced as an academic assessment, I felt a sense of relief and excitement. For a long time, I knew that I needed to create a personal portfolio website to use when applying for jobs and internships. However, I had never fully committed to building one independently because I would not have received professional feedback on whether it met industry expectations. This assignment allowed me to achieve two goals simultaneously: complete an academic assessment and create a professional portfolio I can continue using throughout my career.

I am genuinely grateful for this opportunity because it allowed me to build something that extends beyond the classroom. The website is not simply another assignment submission — it is a platform that represents who I am, my journey, my skills, and my ambitions as an aspiring developer. I would also like to express my appreciation to our lecturer, Isabel Taliad, for creating an assessment with practical value beyond obtaining marks.

From the beginning, I wanted my portfolio to tell a story rather than simply present information. My vision was to create a website that visitors would not only read but experience — reflecting my personal journey, challenges, growth, and aspirations through storytelling. My original concept was far more ambitious than the final product. I envisioned a highly animated portfolio featuring advanced transitions, interactive storytelling elements, and even 3D scenes representing different stages of my development as a programmer.

During research, I discovered modern portfolio websites using advanced 3D graphics and animations that inspired me greatly and sparked an interest in user interface design and immersive web experiences. However, implementing these features would have required significantly more time and expertise than the assignment deadline allowed. Although I was unable to fully achieve my original vision, I am satisfied with the final result because it still captures the essence of what I wanted to communicate and provides a solid foundation for future improvements.

Online Resources Used

To complete this project, I made extensive use of online learning resources. The primary resources I used were W3Schools, GeeksforGeeks, YouTube tutorials, Reddit discussions, Quora discussions, Gemini, Claude Artifacts, and ChatGPT. W3Schools and GeeksforGeeks were particularly useful for reviewing HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and jQuery concepts. Reddit and Quora provided valuable discussions about portfolio design trends, user experience, and

practical development solutions. Claude Artifacts assisted with visual planning and design ideas, while ChatGPT helped with documentation and project organisation.

Tutorials and Articles Referenced

One of the most influential resources I explored was content created by JavaScript Mastery on YouTube. His portfolio tutorials introduced me to modern portfolio design concepts and demonstrated how advanced portfolios can incorporate animations and interactive features. Although I ultimately decided not to follow the complete 3D portfolio approach due to its complexity and steep learning curve, the tutorials inspired many aspects of my design thinking and encouraged me to experiment with more interactive elements.

New Techniques Learned Independently

Throughout the project, I learned several new techniques independently. One of the most significant discoveries was learning how to structure folders and use relative paths effectively. While developing the assignments section of my portfolio, I realised that I could store previous projects and assignments within organised folders and reference them directly from the portfolio. This allowed me to create previews and launch external projects from within the website itself. Before this project, I did not fully appreciate how powerful relative paths could be when organising larger web projects.

Another technique I learned was embedding and referencing PDF documents directly within a website. Prior to this project, I mainly associated embedding with images and multimedia content. Learning how to display and link PDF documents effectively opened new possibilities for presenting certificates, reports, and supporting documentation within a portfolio environment.

Although I was unable to implement the advanced 3D features that initially inspired me, researching those technologies exposed me to new areas of web development that I intend to explore in the future. The experience has increased my interest in modern UI/UX design, web animations, and immersive web experiences.

How Online Examples Were Adapted Into My Own Design

When adapting online examples into my own design, I made a conscious effort not to simply copy tutorials. Instead, I studied concepts and modified them to fit my personal vision. One example is the interactive logo and certificate feature on my website. Inspired by techniques

demonstrated in online tutorials, I implemented a system where the initial logo displays my profile image. When clicked, it directs users to my certificate document. Upon returning, the displayed image changes to the certificate image instead of the original profile picture. This feature reflects my personal creativity while demonstrating how I adapted ideas from external sources into something unique to my portfolio.

Overall, this project challenged me to think beyond simply writing code. It required me to consider storytelling, personal branding, user experience, and professional presentation. While there are many features I still hope to implement in the future, I am proud of what I have accomplished within the available timeframe. Most importantly, this portfolio represents more than a module requirement it is a living project that I can continue to develop and use when pursuing employment opportunities in the software development industry.